draw one's attention. Monolithic columns support the temple from the inside. Visiting it truly feels like stepping out of a time machine. Besides prayer, you can also spend your time cooling off in the scenic Tambdi Surla waterfall close by. Churches are another big draw for tourists to the state. Old Goa was a city which reflected the glory of Rome. The churches and convents were declared a **World Heritage Site in 1986 by UNESCO**. Even for those who don't feel a spiritual calling, several of its churches are wonderful sights to behold. Some of the more popular churches include **The Chapel of St Catherine, The Se Cathedral, The Basilica of Bom Jesus** and **The Church of Divine Providence**. **The Mae De Deus Church or Mother of God Church** in Saligao is one of the most interesting churches to visit in Goa. Built with profound Neo-Gothic architecture, one can't help but marvel at its magical gothic spires that remind you of ancient castles from fairy tales. This church, illuminated under the moonlight is a true spectacle to behold.

FORTS OF GOA

Under the variety of rulers that came to power in Goa over many centuries, the state saw the construction and fortification of several mighty forts. While today, a number of these forts are in ruins, many are being restored. Paying them a visit is sure to give you a glimpse into the rich history of the state and insight into the lives of those who ruled it. There are several to choose from.

The Aguada fort is arguably the most famous fort in Goa. Built in 1612 at a time when Goa was known as 'Little Lisbon' and 'Rome of the East,' it was not only built to fortify the region but also as a port to provide ships with a point to replenish water and other supplies.

Fort Aguada Jail Museum, Aguad

In the 1930s, the Portuguese dictator Salazar turned Aguada into a site to be used to quell revolts and house prisoners of the state. Several of the state's freedom fighters were held in its jail cells.















When Goa was finally liberated from the Portuguese and became part of India, Aguada was converted into Goa Central Jail, used untill 2015. Today, Aguada fort is no longer a prison and has opened its doors to visitors once again. Under the centre's **'Swadesh Darshan Scheme,'** ₹22 crores have been allocated to converting the fort into a contemporary hub of performing arts, music, history, design, food and drink. It has been rechristened as **'Aguad,'** taking inspiration from a reservoir and an ancient aquifer that sit at its heart. Visiting Aguad is a must and offers plenty to do. Enjoy live music, festivals, events and arts and crafts workshops. Marvel at spectacular audio-visual shows. Its star attraction, however, is a digital museum, depicting the state's liberation struggle. Two special cells dedicated to freedom fighters T B Cunha and Ram Manohar Lohia, where they were jailed during Portuguese rule, have been highlighted. Accessed by its own jetty, road, or even helipad, visiting Aguad will not be a challenge.

The Tiracol fort is another well-known Goan fort, located at the northern tip of Goa. What was once an armed fortress that belonged to the Portuguese is now an idyllic hideaway for the discerning traveller. The fort offers awe-inspiring views over the confluence of the river and sea waters as well as a bird's eye view of the Querem and Kalacha beaches.

Tiracol Heritage Hotel Once in ruin, Tiracol fort has been transformed into the **Tiracol Heritage Hotel**. On offer are several charming rooms and suites that come with unique Portuguese and contemporary interiors where you can experience walking through history.

Contact: http://www.forttiracol.in/

Other forts in Goa that are worth visiting include the **forts of Alorna, Chapora, Reis Magos, Khorjuve** and **Cabo Da Rama.**